WordPress Custom Theme & Plugin Architecture Developer Guid

Category: WordPress • Lead Mentor: Nasir • Licensed for Educational Study

1. The WordPress Template Hierarchy

- Template resolution order: single-{post_type}.php -> single.php -> singular.php -> index.php.
- Proper enqueueing: Always register styles and scripts via wp_enqueue_scripts action hook, never hardcoded in header.
- Security: Sanitize on input (sanitize_text_field) and escape on output (esc_html, esc_attr, esc_url).

2. Custom Post Types & REST API Integration

- Register Custom Post Types with register_post_type() specifying show_in_rest => true.
- Add custom endpoints via register_rest_route() with permission_callback validation.
- Headless WordPress: Fetching structured JSON via wp-json/wp/v2/posts for modern React frontend rendering.